MOST IMPROVED BIG STATES ENTREPRENEURSHIP

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 80	RANK 2021
1	UTTAR PRADESH	62.6	1
2	HIMACHAL PRADESH	57.7	4
3	UTTARAKHAND	56.6	2
4	BIHAR	48.6	6
4	MADHYA PRADESH	48.6	5
6	ASSAM	44.9	3
7	HARYANA	44.0	8
8	TELANGANA	42.8	7
9	WEST BENGAL	41.6	14
10	ANDHRA PRADESH	40.8	10
11	KERALA	40.0	9
12	JHARKHAND	39.3	15
13	RAJASTHAN	37.2	11
14	PUNJAB	35.0	12
15	TAMIL NADU	33.0	17
16	CHHATTISGARH	29.3	13
17	ODISHA	28.0	16
18	MAHARASHTRA	27.7	18
19	GUJARAT	27.4	20
20	KARNATAKA	24.5	19

MOST IMPROVED SMALL STATES ENTREPRENEURSHIP

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 80	RANK 2021
1	MANIPUR	64.1	2
2	TRIPURA	59.6	3
3	MIZORAM	47.8	1
4	MEGHALAYA	46.9	5
5	SIKKIM	46.5	8
6	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	45.3	4
7	NAGALAND	41.1	6
8	DELHI	33.1	7
9	GOA	27.6	9
10	PUDUCHERRY	18.1	10

Biren Singh allocated Rs 30 crore to help youngsters set up start-ups based on locally available resources. The government is also supporting sustainable cultivation of local produce that Manipur is known for, such as pineapple, orange, ginger and turmeric. The number of confirmed participants at the festival for the GI tagged Tamenglong orange, to be held on December 19, has gone up to 447 this year. Considering Manipur's rich legacy in handloom textiles, weaving machines have been distributed free of cost by the government. A Rs 30 crore mega handloom cluster is also being set up in the Imphal East district. ■

–Anilesh S. Mahajan, Prashant Srivastava, Amarnath K. Menon and Kaushik Deka

CATEGORY WINNERS **TOURISM**

BUZZING AGAIN

While Kerala finally seems to be emerging from the shadows of mega floods first and then Covid-19, Punjab is betting on big on religious tourism



Two years of the Covid-19 pandemic dealt a massive blow to Indian tourism. Things, however, finally seem to be picking up. Governments have launched fresh policies to attract more footfalls, and the complete lifting of travel restrictions has helped the industry.

Best Performing Big State: Kerala

Kerala seems to be recovering from its dark days that started in 2018 with successive mega floods, and then the Covid-19 lockdowns in 2020. In the first three quarters ending in September, around 13,380,836 domestic tourists visited Kerala. Foreign tourist arrival, however, remains sluggish.

To enhance tourism post the pandemic, the government introduced the Caravan Tourism policy in 2021 promising a customised and close-to-nature travel experience. Being de-